

**Morbius release delayed again**

Morbius release date delayed to April 1 over Omicron concerns.
<https://digit.in/jan22-65>

**Spider-Man:NWH hits \$1.37bn**

Spider-Man: No Way Home box office hits \$1.37 billion, making it Sony's biggest movie ever.
<https://digit.in/jan22-66>

ORIGINS OF VFX

A luxury that's gone on to become a necessity in motion pictures

Paarth Pareek | feedback@digit.in

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his time around, we've got an interesting one for you guys, instead of low key important hardware,

here's something you've all definitely seen and is a vital part of what makes the marvel movies so great! Yes indeed, it's Visual Effects!

THE FIRST

The first ever usage of special effects was done by Oscar Rejlander in 1857 by creating an image named "The Man With The Rubber Head". He did so by combining different sections of 32 negatives into a single image.



Once this was done, We move on to 1895 when Alfred Clark created the first ever motion picture special effect. He was recording a behead-



George Meillies

ing scene of Mary, Queen of Scots. Clark instructed the actress to step up to the stage and then as the executioner brought his axe above her head, Clark stopped the camera, removed the actress, replaced her with a dummy, and then continued filming allowing the executioner to bring his axe down and cut the dummy's head. This made it seem as though the actress' head was actually cut off. Such techniques would then continue to dominate the special effects industry for about a century. This trick would soon be known as the "stop trick". This was not only the first use of trickery in cinema but also the first photographic trickery that was only possible in a motion picture.

Georges Méliès, who was an early motion picture pioneer, accidentally discovered the same "stop trick".

According to Méliès, his camera jammed while filming a street scene in Paris. When he screened the film, he found that the "stop trick" had caused a truck to turn into a hearse, pedestrians to change direction, and men to turn into women. Méliès, the director of the Théâtre Robert-Houdin, was inspired to develop a series of more than 500 short films, between 1896 and 1913, in the process developing or inventing such techniques as multiple exposures, time-lapse photography, dissolves, and hand painted color.

Because of his ability to manipulate reality with the cinematograph, Méliès is sometimes referred to as the "Cinemagician."

In films such as Indian Rubber Head (1902) and the 21 minute epic (for the time) A Trip to the Moon (also 1902) he pioneered a range of VFX techniques such as the split screen / double exposure process, and was very much part of the European movement that saw film as a loose narrative joining together special effects sequences. This would eventually cause his downfall as audiences started wanting more sophisticated, narratively focussed fare, but over the course of 500 titles and 10 years he pushed the technology as far as any individual in the early period.

